



PROGRESS REPORT

Connectivity: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27

Edition of 2026-08-27 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

31 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

CHAD · ESWATINI · LESOTHO · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITANIA · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE · SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · SOUTH SUDAN · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE · AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Chad

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
N'Djamena to Mbere fibre corridor memorandum	Memorandum signed in April 2025, with a neighbouring incumbent committing the following month to build the connecting section, and no work started	Suspended by the regulator over clauses deemed contrary to national digital sovereignty; the ministry issued observations and guidelines and invited renegotiation, and work is still not started	REGRESSED
Network investment programme of the larger mobile operator	The minister told the National Assembly on 2025-09-23 that the operator had promised FCFA 16bn in the short term and FCFA 10bn in the medium term, and that this had never been done	FCFA 50bn announced through June 2026 for microwave reinforcement, new towers, fibre extension and core-network upgrade; the deadline passed and the ministry's verdict on operator investment in June 2026 was that nothing is felt	STALLED
Order to the two mobile operators to connect to the national fibre backbone	Did not exist	The seven-day deadline passed with no recorded compliance; in late June 2026 the minister was still encouraging one operator to connect and criticising its reliance on subcontractors for equipment, technical staff and site maintenance	STALLED
Projet de modernisation des infrastructures de connectivite de l'Etat	Under construction since the foundation stone of 2020-07-07, with the EUR 175.1m first phase not commenced and no delivery figure published	First phase commenced at EUR 175,106,916 covering the national data centre, a 1,200 km fibre backbone, second- to fourth-generation mobile expansion, a conference and messaging system and 100 branch offices; no source reports kilometres laid, masts erected or the state operator's core commissioned	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Starlink operating licence	Licence signed 2025-03-13 on an approval dated November 2024, with no commercial service on sale	On sale from 2025-07-04 at FCFA 12,000 a month for 50 GB, FCFA 18,000 for 250 GB and FCFA 32,000 unlimited; confirmed in October 2025 as a multiservice internet-provider licence granted on application after a favourable technical opinion and without public tender, and a floated upgrade to full operator status was closed a month later	ADVANCED
TCHADIX internet exchange point	Operational since about May 2025, with no published traffic, membership or peering figure	One year operational and constituted as an economic interest grouping with adopted statutes and a reconfirmed bureau; still no published traffic volume, member count or peering figure	ADVANCED, INSTITUTIONALISED
Trans-Saharan fibre-optic backbone, Chadian section	32 per cent complete at a ministerial field visit of 2025-03-06, works having been launched in May 2023 on an initial ten-month schedule	60 per cent complete; a mission to Bol in January 2026 found broken windows and degradation at the technical building housing equipment, and the project coordinator conceded a slowdown from difficulty mobilising control missions	ADVANCED, STILL FAR BEHIND SCHEDULE
Fifty telecom sites and fifty kilometres of fibre to the home at N'Djamena	No position held	Announced through the state operator with no timeline, financing or coverage areas specified, and no build reported	BASELINE NOT HELD
Twenty-year concession for a border-to-border fibre link	No position held	A twenty-year build-operate-transfer concession from the Sudanese border to Cameroon, with a funding commitment of FCFA 20.5bn from European and continental development financiers; no progress has been made	BASELINE NOT HELD

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mbabane smart-city deployment	Did not exist	Under installation; no completion date published	ADVANCED
Minimum internet service standard	2 Mbps minimum	10 Mbps proposed; the 2 Mbps standard remains in force	ADVANCED
National fibre-optic backbone	47 Gbps international capacity	72 Gbps international capacity; rollout continuing	ADVANCED
Public-institution connectivity programme	Did not exist	859 schools, 134 health facilities and 38 tinkhundla centres to be connected	ADVANCED
Mobile coverage against mobile-internet use	About 95% 4G coverage against about 58% internet use	95% mobile coverage against 57% mobile-internet subscription (2026-07)	NO CHANGE
Statutory complaint adjudication by ESCCOM	In force	In force	NO CHANGE
Cost of data as a share of income per head	Baseline not held	3.47% of gross national income per head	BASELINE NOT HELD

Lesotho

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network (LEMOFI)	Did not exist	Feasibility study completed, laying groundwork for expanding high-speed broadband connectivity across major towns; construction not reported	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet service	Live through T-Connect, the sole reseller	Live through T-Connect, and reported also carried over Vodacom low-earth-orbit backhaul (2026-01)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Vodacom Lesotho mobile network	A network upgrade pledged at the group chief executive's visit (2025-08)	1.21m customers and 85% market share, 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, and 2G 97%, 3G 98% and 4G 96% coverage (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Econet Telecom Lesotho 5G network	149 5G sites on 700MHz (2025-06)	149 5G sites on 700MHz; no later figure held	NO CHANGE
Econet Wi-Fi Plus fixed-mobile convergence service	In service	In service; nothing later on record	NO CHANGE
Starlink operating licence	Granted, and contested over 100% foreign ownership	Granted; nothing later on record resolves the local-shareholding objection	NO CHANGE

Libya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
5G network	Did not exist	One operator live in central Tripoli, countrywide roll-out stated to follow	ADVANCED
ARABSAT and LTT satellite capacity agreement	Did not exist	Agreement announced; capacity on Arabsat-6A at 30.5 degrees east, no commercial terms	ADVANCED
Ghat to Tahala fibre link	In service	11 of 12 sites restored, 91.7%, most on VSAT backup	REGRESSED, LARGELY RESTORED
LPTIC and KBR infrastructure and 5G memorandum	Did not exist	MoU only	ADVANCED
LPTIC and Nokia 5G cooperation	Did not exist	Discussion only	ADVANCED
LTT and ZTE modernisation memorandum	Did not exist	Framework covering 4G/5G, e-wallet, e-commerce, CDN and terminals	ADVANCED
National IPv4 to IPv6 transition	None published	Operators convened; no timetable or target published	ADVANCED
National root servers	Did not exist	Operating in Almadar Aljadid data centres in Tripoli and Benghazi	ADVANCED
Huawei's authorisation to operate	Operating; suspended nationwide on 17 August 2025	Operating under a compliance undertaking to the GTI; scoping civil-service systems (2026-07)	NO CHANGE, SUSPENDED AND REINSTATED WITHIN THREE DAYS
Medusa submarine cable	Inaugurated at Misrata; Tripoli and Benghazi landings planned (2025-05)	Same; no landing or capacity figure published since	NO CHANGE

Madagascar

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G-Advanced trial (Yas and Huawei)	Did not exist	Trial run; no commercial 5G service on record (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Airtel and Eutelsat OneWeb rural broadband	Not on record	Partnership deepened; no rural site count or subscriber figure published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Antananarivo-Mahajanga fibre backbone (Orange)	Did not exist	558 km in service, built by the country's third fibre operator (2025-12)	ADVANCED
DARE1 subsea cable extension to Madagascar	No subsea extension on record	Extension announced on a 3,200-3,500 km leg via Tanzania and Mozambique, ready for service 2028	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital and Energy Connectivity for Inclusion project (DECIM)	US\$375m envelope with the rural-connectivity tender document due end-October 2025	Tender document slipped to January 2026; 664,000 devices distributed by the June 2026 review	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Starlink Direct-to-Cell service	Did not exist	First trial run on Airtel spectrum, the third African country to do so; commercial launch pending the regulator (2026-07)	ADVANCED
AXIAN 4G and 5G expansion programme	US\$82m of the operator's own investment and a US\$100m EIB loan committed (2025-04)	Unchanged; no coverage or site figure published since	NO CHANGE
Satellite connectivity for ten enclaved zones (DECIM)	Announced, nothing connected	Announced, nothing connected; no site or date published	NO CHANGE

Malawi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Additional mobile operator licensing round	Did not exist; no proposal for a new licensing round appears in the base at 2025-08-01	The ICT minister told Parliament that additional operator licences were under consideration, and that the President had authorised the ministry to identify an investor able to roll out a network without delay; no bid timetable, licence terms or spectrum allocation is stated. The minister conceded that foreign-exchange shortages constrain incumbents' equipment imports and that earlier licensees who took spectrum without launching had licences revoked, ending in litigation	ADVANCED
Airtel Malawi satellite connectivity plan	Did not exist; no operator satellite position appears in the base at 2025-08-01	Interest signalled in satellite connectivity to complement terrestrial networks in hard-to-reach areas and improve resilience; no partner, licence, capital allocation or timetable is stated	ADVANCED
Communication tower programme	Did not exist as a named line; the acceleration project appraisal itemises component allocations and carries no tower-infrastructure line, the nearest being rural connectivity at US\$20m	The regulator advancing procurement for more than 90 towers, with the project stated as committed to around 100; a study cited at the same meeting puts the requirement for nationwide coverage above 1,000 towers. No contract award, site list or completion date is on record	ADVANCED
Converged Technology Networks fixed-wireless network	<i>Baseline not held</i>	4G LTE fixed-wireless coverage extended to Areas 9, 25 and 36, Airwing and Chitipi, taking the network to nineteen named neighbourhoods across the capital, with free long-term connectivity for more than twenty secondary schools under a partnership with unconnected.org and the Internet Society	ADVANCED
Digital Malawi Acceleration Project	Approved 2024-06-27 and launched November 2024 at a total operation cost of US\$90.00m, a US\$70.00m grant plus US\$20.00m unguaranteed commercial financing, with targets of 2,000 schools, 500 further government offices, digital ID enrolment and an affordable-devices programme; no delivery recorded	Procurement of service providers for more than 90 towers being advanced, the national data centre being upgraded to an AI-ready state, and 25 e-services being onboarded to the data-exchange platform	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Four-year ICT investment plan	Did not exist; no such investment plan appears in the base at 2025-08-01	A proposed US\$180m four-year plan built round two projects: a one-stop digital government platform covering passport applications, business registration and tax payments; and a high-speed network linking all 28 districts with ring protection against cable failures. Funding structure, implementation timeline and any agreements reached have not been made public	ADVANCED
Harmonised national broadband mapping	Did not exist	The regulator hosted a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training at Lilongwe for broadband-mapping practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, under a 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators, supported by the European Union	ADVANCED
Malcel licence	Licensed as Malawi's intended third major mobile operator, targeting a late-2023 commercial launch, delayed by macroeconomic conditions, with no new date announced	Unchanged at 2026-07-20; still no commercial launch and no announced date	STALLED
Satellite connectivity for rural schools	Did not exist as a deployment; at 2025-08-01 the base records only that technical assistance had prepared the regulator to enable low-earth-orbit satellite services	30 rural schools connected, reported as serving 100,000 students and 1,500 teachers (company-announced); responsibility for the recurring subscription cost is not stated	ADVANCED
Tariff-notice requirement under the Communications Act 2016	In force, requiring approved tariff changes to be published in at least two daily newspapers seven days before taking effect; the base holds no record of enforcement	The regulator found both mobile operators in breach in respect of the 26 June to 2 July 2026 notice window, and both agreed to credit affected customers with bundles equal to the price difference by 2026-07-31 with evidence of compliance, alongside strengthened internal compliance procedures; the approved price increase itself stands	ADVANCED
Access Communications licence	Licensed 2007, holding a small share of mobile subscribers and available mainly in major cities	Unchanged at 2026-07-20; has not significantly challenged the two-operator duopoly	NO CHANGE
Last Mile Connectivity and National Data Centre loan	A China Construction Bank commercial loan covering 136 tower installations and last-mile fibre, with the first tower launched at Mbvunguti Village on 2020-06-13 and 28 towers expected in the then-current phase	Unchanged; no progress report, disbursement figure or completion statement is held, and no account of how this project relates to the Lilongwe data centre built under the World Bank project	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Malawi Digital Foundations Project	Closed since October 2024; US\$72.4m committed and US\$72.6m disbursed, having delivered the Lilongwe national data centre, the national data-exchange platform and the first phase of e-procurement, connected some 640 government sites against a target of 400, and over 100 free public Wi-Fi spots	Unchanged; the base holds no post-closure evaluation and no independent verification of the reported results, which are the lender's own	NO CHANGE
National Fibre Backbone Project, Phases I and II	Phase I financed by a China Eximbank government concessional loan of CNY 155,432,330, committed 2016 and running 2017 to 2018, recorded as closed. Phase II financed by a concessional loan of CNY 693,000,000 at 1% over 20 years, committed 2020 with start year 2021, on-lent to the electricity utility, with CNY 299,286,770 drawn as at June 2023 and first repayment falling due 2027-03-21	Unchanged; the base holds the two loan records and no statement of route kilometres, completion, operator or current operating status	NO CHANGE
Nyasa Mobile licence	Licensed in 2022, with operational delays attributed to economic conditions and no commercial launch date announced	Unchanged at 2026-07-20	NO CHANGE
Spectrum licence fee reduction	A 20% reduction in radio-frequency spectrum licence fees across all bands, announced following review of the regulator's 2016 incentive pricing model; no fee schedule, gazette notice or statutory instrument is held, so the base amounts and the date the reduced fees took effect are unknown	Unchanged. On 2026-07-17 the ICT minister told Parliament the reduction was 50%; the base treats that as a misstatement of the 2025 measure, since five contemporaneous accounts of the regulator's own announcement say 20% and no source records a second reduction	NO CHANGE
TNM 5G network	Launched at the international conference centre in Lilongwe with a vendor as technical partner, the first 5G network in Malawi, with coverage stated only for Lilongwe and four further cities named as extension targets	Unchanged; the base holds no later site count or coverage figure	NO CHANGE
Wholesale international bandwidth price	Fell from about US\$460 per Mbit/s per month at project start in 2017 to below US\$10 at close in 2024	Unchanged; the base holds no wholesale price for 2025 or 2026, so whether the gain has held is not established	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Airtel Malawi 5G sites in service	No figure held at 2025-08-01	111 sites across 10 districts (company-reported), after 58 new sites added on MWK 50.8bn of network capital expenditure in the 2025 financial year	BASELINE NOT HELD
Incumbent mobile operator network investment	Not held	US\$31m stated by the second mobile operator as invested to expand network capacity and coverage nationally, to meet growing voice and data demand	BASELINE NOT HELD
Mobile and internet subscriber and coverage series	Baseline not held	An industry association report puts fourth-generation coverage at 87% of the population against mobile-internet penetration of 12.5%, with mobile-money adoption described as near universal; the same report scores Malawi 36 of 100 on its digital nations and society index and 55 of 100 on policy and regulation	BASELINE NOT HELD
Schools with limited or no internet access	No school-connectivity figure held at 2025-08-01	85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none, with lack of electricity and of digital devices named as the main barriers; the 2026/27 national budget carries no dedicated line for school internet connectivity, the World Bank is separately supporting connection of over 200 schools, and the acceleration project targets 2,000	BASELINE NOT HELD

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ADSL retirement and FTTH migration	Did not exist	Announced; no subscriber or coverage figure published	ADVANCED
International route diversity through the CSquared backbone	Inland routes exposed to the Abidjan, Accra and Lagos landing concentration	An independent subsea route with automated rerouting behind the inland backbone	ADVANCED
Moov Africa Malitel fibre	Fibre plans at previous speeds	Up to 100 Mbps across six cities	ADVANCED
Orange Mali 4G and fibre expansion	Did not exist	300 4G towers, half of them rural, and fibre to about 300,000 households in build	ADVANCED
SMTD-SA as sole national transport-infrastructure operator	Did not exist	Recommended as a law; nothing tabled	ADVANCED
Starlink kit imports	Six-month lifting of the import ban reported October 2024; prohibition on unauthorised equipment restated with a warning of sanctions 2026-03-12	Control, seizure and dismantling operations announced against unauthorised Starlink, Wi-Fi Zone and walkie-talkie equipment nationwide, with operators ordered to cease immediately	REGRESSED
Universal connectivity target	None published	Targeted for 2030 with a roadmap drafted with Burkina Faso and Niger	ADVANCED
Independent internet service providers	One independent provider reported surviving	AFRIBONE reported the sole surviving independent provider, on wholesale IP transit bought at near-retail prices	NO CHANGE
Orange Mali satellite 3G and 4G	In service	In service; no later coverage figure published	NO CHANGE

Mauritania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G licences	Did not exist; the process opened on 2 December 2025	Four fifteen-year licences to Mauritel, Mattel, Chinguitel and the new entrant Rimatel, bids of MRU 252.6m to 305m plus 5% of revenue; Chinguitel launched the country's first commercial 5G network in Nouakchott on 10 August 2026, no coverage footprint or subscriber figure published The second operator launched its network at Nouakchott on 10 August 2026 under the digital transformation minister; no coverage, tariff or subscriber figure is stated.	ADVANCED
EllaLink second submarine cable	Project launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025: 669 km, 200 Gb/s rising to 12 Tbit/s, EIB and EU financed	Phase-1 coastal landing complete at Nouadhibou, offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED
IPv6 deployment across operator networks	Adopted as a strategy in 2024 with no operator activation reported	All operators have activated IPv6, with one unnamed operator past 15% of subscribers migrated (2026-07) against a 25% end-2026 target	ADVANCED
Satellite internet licences	Did not exist; the tender opened on 22 January 2026	BRAINSAT, VDM and Mattel provisionally retained from nine bids, with VDM and Mattel required to match BRAINSAT's offer; no award, launch date or operating framework published	ADVANCED
ACE submarine cable landing	The country's only international cable	The country's only international cable in service	NO CHANGE
MEDUSA cable, sub-Saharan component	Financed, with no landing on record	Financed; no landing, route or commissioning date is on record	NO CHANGE
Chinguitel network modernisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Completed; no coverage, capacity or subscriber figure was published with it	Baseline not held
Sahel digital connectivity support	BASELINE NOT HELD	Announced; no site, capacity or delivery figure for Mauritania is published	Baseline not held

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
America-India Connect cable participation	Did not exist	A prime-ministerial commitment to join, behind which sits a signed non-disclosure agreement and unfinished technical, legal and financial negotiation; no consortium confirmation, landing point, capacity, cost or service date is published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Mauritius Telecom 2026-2029 strategy	Did not exist	A reported Rs 20bn programme across connectivity, financial services, artificial intelligence and compute, and innovation; no delivery milestone has been published against it (2026-01)	ADVANCED
T4 and SEACOM 2.0 landings	Did not exist as a published plan	Named as planned landings, with T4 to replace the retiring SAFE cable; no contract, cost or date published (2026-01)	ADVANCED
International submarine cable landings	Landings on SAFE, LION, LION2 and METISS, with SAFE due to retire around 2027 (2025-07)	Unchanged in service; LION and LION2 still carry most international traffic and the stated driver for new capacity is infrastructure ageing (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Satellite broadband authorisation regime	In force (2025-08)	Unchanged: service only through a locally licensed provider, a local point of presence with Mauritian-geolocated addresses, real-time terminal dashboards and provider-retained terminal ownership. No satellite service has been authorised under it (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Morocco

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G commercial mobile service	Licence tender open, no commercial service (2025-07)	In service on 3.5 GHz and 700 MHz; 3.2m 5G subscribers, 8.4% of mobile-internet users (regulator, 2026-03)	ADVANCED
5G licence specification and coverage obligations	Not held	Coverage floor: 8 cities plus airports by November 2025, 25% of population by end-2026, 70% by end-2030; terms: maximum 3 licences, 20-year renewable, 50-100MHz at 3GHz plus 2x10MHz at 700MHz, MAD 60m per licence for band reorganisation; corrects the conflicting 45%/85% figure held elsewhere; bidders' own coverage commitments are not disclosed in the report	ADVANCED
5G licences	Competitive tender launched, no licences awarded (2025-07)	Three licences awarded and in commercial service; the regulator stated it would assess operators after the first operational year; IAM's 20-year renewable licence is now individually gazetted; the cahier des charges' five annexes (shareholding, frequencies, coverage engagements, quality of service, interference procedure) are withheld as confidential though binding; the Arabic text prevails in courts	ADVANCED
5G subscribers	Did not exist, pre-launch	3.2m subscribers, 8.4% of mobile-internet users (2026-03), from 2.63m and 38% outdoor population coverage at Q4 2025	ADVANCED
Dual-band radio deployment on rail and motorway corridors	Did not exist	In commercial service; the operator and vendor claim a 13 dB coverage gain, 83% higher average downlink throughput and 3.2 times the active users, with no additional sites built. The vendor puts the deployment at roughly a kilometre of extra range, an 83% download-speed gain and 3.2 times more concurrent users per site; the regulator put the operator at 19.4m mobile subscriptions, a 34.04% share and a market-leading 41.83% of mobile internet at the end of March 2026	ADVANCED
Median mobile download speed after the 5G launch	44.4 Mbps 4G median one week before launch (2025-11)	5G median down 38% from 261.7 Mbps at launch to about 160-165 Mbps; 4G median down 28%; combined median 44.59 Mbps at month six	REGRESSED
Mobile interconnection tariff symmetry	Asymmetric mobile interconnection tariffs	Transitional phase running 2026-07-01 to 2027-01-31, full symmetry from 2027-02-01	ADVANCED
Regulator's telecommunications market observatory	Not held	First regulator-own periodic observatory held (not via a measurement firm): mobile park 57.06m (-0.58% y/y), penetration 154.93%, outgoing traffic -18.79% y/y, SMS -9.12%, fixed lines 3.262m (+5.05%), FTTH 1.5m (about 52% of wireline internet), sector revenue +2.89%	ADVANCED
Satellite terminal licence renewal	In force, prior expiry not stated	Renewed to 2035	ADVANCED
Medusa subsea cable Morocco landing	Supplier selected; no Moroccan landing date (2025-07)	Same; nothing further on file	NO CHANGE
Shared fibre and tower joint ventures	Formed, sharing fibre and 5G assets (2025-04)	Same; no further reporting on file	NO CHANGE
Starlink licence	Local subsidiary registered 2024-11-11 with capital of MAD 1,000; no licence	Same; regulator negotiations reported continuing, and the operator's own map lists the Morocco service date as unknown	NO CHANGE
Fibre-to-the-home passive infrastructure sharing	BASELINE NOT HELD	Prerequisites completed April 2026; commercial opening scheduled 2026-04-27	Baseline not held

Mozambique

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G coverage plan to 2027 and 2030	None published	Provincial capitals, special economic zones and main tourist destinations by 2027; all districts and administrative posts by 2030	ADVANCED
5G licence terms and coverage obligations	Did not exist	Spectrum licences issued to the three operators carry a deadline of June 2027 for 5G service in every provincial capital, the same package covering urban centres, industrial zones, economic poles and strategic tourism destinations, with 4G expansion obligations reaching border, rural and other territorial-integration areas in a later phase. Two operators put on record that many target localities have no grid electricity, roads or fibre or microwave backhaul	ADVANCED
5G spectrum assignment (700 MHz, 2.6 and 3.5 GHz)	No 5G spectrum assigned and no bidding process open (2025-08)	Three operators licensed for 5G and 4G expansion, with a first phase covering provincial capitals, major urban centres, industrial zones, economic hubs and dense areas and extending to coastal and inland tourist areas, national parks and reserves; Vodafone reports 210 MHz to Vodacom Mozambique for US\$56m with payment and licence terms still being finalised (quarter ended 2026-06-30)	ADVANCED
Chanida-Cassacatiza cross-border fibre interconnector	Did not exist	In service, linking Zambia's national backbone to Mozambique's submarine cable network; built by Bayobab Zambia and Vodacom	ADVANCED
DARE1 subsea cable southern extension	Not announced	Planned landings in Tanzania, Mozambique, Madagascar and South Africa, interconnecting at Mombasa; Mombasa-Durban route estimated at 3,200-3,500 km; no construction start confirmed at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
National broadband coverage portal	Did not exist	Public geospatial platform built with Esri and Cellular Expert; operator coverage and speeds queryable by location, with a public gap-reporting channel	ADVANCED
Rural Connectivity Project (FSAU)	Tender open for at least 30 pre-selected sites, bids due 2025-09-19	60 mobile stations across nine provinces awarded to Vodacom, each with 2G and 4G, a public Wi-Fi multimedia centre, solar power, a prepaid public telephone and 100 handsets; no completion date on record at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Visabeira control of TV Cabo and Televisa	Visabeira held 50% of each, subject to a TMCEL repurchase option running to end-2025	Notified purchase of TMCEL's residual 30% in each company, taking Visabeira to 80% and exclusive control; under review, no transaction amount disclosed	ADVANCED
Administrative posts and localities without mobile coverage	6 of 453 administrative posts uncovered and 209 of 1,222 localities uncovered, 82.9% locality coverage (2024)	Same; no later figure published at 2026-08-09	NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED
Internet Para Todos	Programme running with 2030 targets	Running; INCM states targets of 80% mobile penetration, 95% territory coverage and 99% network availability by 2030	NO CHANGE
Localities and schools connected under the ministry's programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	149 localities and 418 schools connected, against a stated target of at least 300 localities, up to 4,000 schools and around 10,000 new 4G and 5G access points (2026-08)	Baseline not held
Nacala-Lobito submarine cable	BASELINE NOT HELD	In design phase; no route length, cost, financier or in-service date stated	Baseline not held
Sale of part of the state stake in the incumbent operator	Not held	The government has formed a technical team to negotiate the sale of part of the state's stake in the loss-making incumbent, which carried a US\$400m debt in 2023	BASELINE NOT HELD

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink service in Mozambique	BASELINE NOT HELD	Live, with a Vodacom low-earth-orbit backhaul and equipment-resale partnership; SpaceX donated terminals that INCM deployed at flood accommodation and coordination centres in February 2026	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Commercial 5G network	No active commercial 5G network (ministry, 2025-06-03)	Live in Windhoek, Swakopmund and Walvis Bay; nationwide deployment stated as intended, phased and city-first	ADVANCED
Determination of dominant position in the telecommunications market	2016 determination (Government Gazette 6054, General Notice 214, 28 June 2016) defined the four priority markets carried forward in 2024: fixed and mobile call/SMS termination, wired end-user access, national data transmission, and wireless end-user access	2024 determination names Telecom Namibia dominant in all four markets - alone in wired end-user access, with NamPower in national data transmission, with MTC in wireless end-user access, and with MTC, UCom Mobile, Paratus and Telepassport in call and SMS termination, termination being treated as a natural monopoly; CRAN describes its approach across all three exercises (2013, 2016, 2024) as one of minimal intervention	ADVANCED
First privately owned mobile network	Announced, not launched (2025-08-19)	A national network live on long-term evolution and 5G; N\$600m invested in the network in the preceding year and N\$1.42bn in Namibian network infrastructure since 2018, company-reported	ADVANCED
Ministry strategic plan 2025-2030 and national ICT policy	None published	In force; priorities are affordable broadband and mobile coverage in rural and underserved areas, cybersecurity, data protection and electronic government; the policy names high data costs, limited infrastructure and unequal access as the barriers	ADVANCED
Regional subsea and satellite integration agreement	None published	Signed by the state fixed operator with two Angolan counterparts, with the Namibian operator as landing party hosting Angolan equipment; scope covers design, integration, testing, commissioning and handover	ADVANCED
Retirement of 2G and 3G networks	Did not exist	The regulator has instructed operators to retire 2G and 3G and refarm the spectrum for 4G and 5G; the incumbent asked government at a parliamentary committee hearing on 17 August 2026 to subsidise smartphones before the switch-off, and reported 53 sites in one Kavango region against 39 in the other, of which 50 carry 4G and one 5G	ADVANCED
Starlink operating licence	An ownership-exemption bid under ministerial review; no licence; a November 2024 cease-and-desist in force	Licence and spectrum declined 2026-03-23 on three of six statutory criteria; 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed the legal threshold and two were refused on merits; the operator's own request of 2026-06-08 was dismissed as out of time	CLOSED
Tower-siting engagement with traditional authorities	None published	The ministry, the regulator and three operators met the traditional authorities' trust on siting delays and costs; no agreement, instrument or timetable reported	ADVANCED
Twenty-five-tower programme	Not yet inaugurated (2025-08-01)	Twenty-five towers in service across nine regions at N\$40m in total, N\$1.6m each, company-reported	ADVANCED
51% Namibian ownership requirement	In force, with a foreign-ownership exemption bid under ministerial review	In force; no exemption granted, and the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
CRAN Integrated Annual Report	Integrated Annual Report 2024 (approved 2024-09-06, year to 31 March 2024): a funding proposal secured a N\$115 million, three-year Universal Service Fund commitment from the Government of Namibia; broadband coverage of schools rose 31.5 points to 81.5% and of clinics 38.9 points to 88.9%; total assets N\$277.9 million, up N\$29.6 million	Integrated Annual Report 2025 (approved 2025-08-07, year to 31 March 2025): the Universal Service Fund's governance framework was approved and the Fund launched 2025-03-19 with the N\$115 million MICT commitment; a first bidding round awarded nine sites to MTC with almost N\$31 million capital subsidy across Kunene, Kavango East, Kavango West, Ohangwena and Oshikoto, with free internet for schools and clinics on the new sites for seven years; revenue fell 23% to 15.5% below budget, operating expenditure rose 42% to N\$143.1 million, and a N\$32.8 million surplus became a N\$25.5 million loss; 4G population coverage 91% and an ITU ICT Development Index of 73.2% are separately stated	NO CHANGE
Regulator coverage and subscriber statistics	Published to 2023 data	Published inside the sector market reports: 4G population coverage 85% in 2022, with six of Namibia's 14 regions below 80% and Kunene lowest at 41%; 456 of 1,380 schools and 84 of 452 health facilities without 4G coverage in 2022; about 2,000,000 of 2,900,000 mobile SIM cards actively used for internet access in 2022; and state influence over 87% of telecommunication assets and 83% of sector revenue in 2022, moving to 82% and 80% in 2023; the 2023 edition separately gives 4G population coverage of 88.4%, FTTH at 27% of fixed broadband subscribers (more than double its 2018 share), a 6% fall in active SIM cards, and a rise from 46th to 8th in African 1GB-affordability ranking between Q1 2022 and Q1 2023, which CRAN attributes to its own broadband-price consultation	NO CHANGE
Tax relief on fourth-generation devices	BASELINE NOT HELD	Proposed; no fiscal instrument, budget line or ministerial response published, against an operator-reported utilisation close to 50% across about 74 enabled towers in the region	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Continuous mobile-network monitoring platform	Did not exist	In service, giving the regulator real-time visibility of operator networks	ADVANCED
Domestic national fibre backbone	Did not exist	2,275 km of fibre across three domestic sections - Niamey-Tillabery, Zinder-Diffa, Agadez-Tahoua - built under an RMB 623.7m (about US\$103.8m, constant 2023 dollars) China Eximbank concessional loan signed 2014-01-02, aimed at raising national broadband coverage from 54% to 72%	ADVANCED
Niamey Internet Exchange Point	Did not exist	In service, letting domestic networks exchange traffic locally	ADVANCED
Telco-integrated satellite service	Did not exist	Live, with the operator rather than the customer holding the satellite relationship	ADVANCED
Trans-Sahara fibre backbone	None in service	1,031 km accepted on five axes - Arlit-Assamaka to Algeria (220 km), Diffa-N'Guigmi to Chad (186 km), Zinder-Magaria to Nigeria (117 km), Niamey-Dosso-Gaya to Benin (300 km), Niamey-Makalondi to Burkina Faso (118 km) - plus an 88 km loop to the national data centre, under a project launched under NEPAD in 2017 with works from 2021	ADVANCED
Starlink retail service	Commercially available through approved sellers	Commercially available through approved sellers	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mobile network quality of service	BASELINE NOT HELD	Voice and mobile-data quality found deficient at all four operators in the April-May 2026 control, with a verification campaign running to 2026-08-28	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Fixed broadband speed and technology mix	Median fixed download speed 13.50 Mbps in 2023, with fixed wireless access the largest fixed-broadband technology and 84,141 fibre-to-the-premises connections at the fourth quarter of 2025	Fibre overtook fixed wireless access as the largest fixed-broadband technology for the first time, with fibre-to-the-premises connections at 265,000 by June 2026 and the median fixed download speed at 34.47 Mbps in the first half of 2026, a rise of 155%, upload speeds nearly doubled to 25.17 Mbps and latency down from 47.9 ms to 35.8 ms; the gain sits at the bottom of the distribution, the slowest decile improving from 2.24 Mbps to 6.04 Mbps while the fastest moved only from 74.37 Mbps to 90.04 Mbps	ADVANCED
IFC financing for Airtel Africa network upgrades	Did not exist	US\$150m for network upgrades	ADVANCED
Mobile and broadband subscriber base	50% broadband penetration (2025-11)	157m internet subscribers (2026-05), from 154.3m (2026-04); 188m mobile subscriptions and broadband penetration 55.67% (2026-04)	ADVANCED
MTN 400G and 800G optical backbone with Huawei	Did not exist	400G and 800G optical backbone with Huawei	ADVANCED
MTN acquisition of IHS Towers	Did not exist	Shareholders of the tower company approved the acquirer's cash buyout of the 75.3% it does not already own; the target's first-half 2026 revenue rose 8.2% to US\$844m while rising Nigerian diesel costs and acquisition-related charges cut operating income 38%, and it has exited Latin America to concentrate on African tower operations. Federal strategic review of the transaction is the last position the base holds on the state's side	ADVANCED
MTN fibre-to-the-home programme	Did not exist	In build against an 8m-home target for 2028	ADVANCED
NCC network performance reporting with Ookla	Did not exist	Two editions of crowdsourced urban and rural measurement published	ADVANCED
NIGCOMSAT-2A and 2B satellites	Did not exist	Cabinet approval for the acquisition and deployment of two high-throughput communications satellites, to be delivered by Thales Alenia Space and Israel Aerospace Industries with NIGCOMSAT implementing under the communications ministry, on an operator timetable of NIGCOMSAT-2A by end-2028 and NIGCOMSAT-2B in 2029 or 2030	ADVANCED
Nigeria-Equatorial Guinea subsea cable	Did not exist	Cable bundled with a commercial data centre	ADVANCED
Project BRIDGE national open-access fibre	Announced (2025-05)	US\$1.6bn World Bank-appraised envelope, superseding the ~US\$2bn announced 2025-05-18; SPV incorporated as Bridge Open Access (Bridge OA), with private investors at 51-75% and the state at 25-49%; the communications minister stated on 2026-08-20 that implementation of the 90,000km rollout begins in October 2026 and that the funding has been raised, against the 2027 start for physical deployment the project documents carry	ADVANCED
Protection of telecom infrastructure from vandalism and access denial	<i>Baseline not held</i>	155,397 fibre cuts in April-May 2026 alone (74,276 April, 79,121 May), more than 54,000 attributed to vandalism	REGRESSED
Removal of the 5% telecom excise duty	5% excise in force	Removed	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Spectrum Roadmap 2026-2030	Did not exist	Assignable IMT spectrum to rise from 1.07 GHz to about 3.8 GHz by 2030, against targets of at least 96% 4G population coverage and at least 50% for 5G	ADVANCED
9mobile national roaming on MTN	Live (2025-05)	Roaming live; T2 Mobile flat at 802,534 internet subscribers (2026-05), no visible recovery	NO CHANGE
Internet Exchange Point of Nigeria traffic	1 Tbps (2025-04)	Above 1 Tbps	NO CHANGE
Mobile broadband population coverage	4G LTE 84.60% and 5G 13.28% of population (2024-12)	4G about 85% and 5G about 13% of population (2025), against 2030 targets of at least 96% and at least 50%	NO CHANGE
Sweden network quality-of-experience project	Running (2025-02)	Running	NO CHANGE
Telecom tariff reset	In force (2025-01)	In force; the first rise in about 11 years	NO CHANGE
Airtel Nigeria retail and distribution network	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 17,200 sites, from about 13,000 three years earlier	Baseline not held
Akwa Ibom airport internet backbone	BASELINE NOT HELD	A multi-gigabit backbone activated at the state's international airport over a commercial submarine-fibre network, intended to carry passenger processing, operations and real-time security monitoring	Baseline not held
FiberOne broadband footprint	None published	Live in five cities, six further states named for launch before the end of 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Fibre cuts from road works	Baseline not held	More than 5,000 fibre-optic cable cuts from road works in the first half of 2026, on the regulator's own count	BASELINE NOT HELD
Free-space optical links in Lagos	BASELINE NOT HELD	Close to twelve licence-exempt optical links across Lagos, on the companies' own account; the operator puts nearly a dozen light-beam links in service across Lagos over two years, serving banks, hotels, internet providers and a utility beyond fibre's reach, with plans to extend to Abuja, Ibadan and Kano	Baseline not held
Length of the national fibre backbone	Baseline not held	30,000 km of terrestrial fibre deployed against the 120,000 km the national blueprint requires, with the financier's appraisal stating flatly that there is no national backbone network; the same financier's Board-approval statement frames the BRIDGE programme as laying over 90,000 km and extending the backbone from 35,000 km to 125,000 km	BASELINE NOT HELD
Telecoms sector capital expenditure	BASELINE NOT HELD	About ₦2.13tn invested in 2025 with about ₦1.86tn planned for 2026, on the operators' association's own figures	Baseline not held
Universal communication access tower deployment	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 3,700 towers to be deployed from October 2026 for more than 20 million people in unserved and underserved communities, with a first tower being installed in Delta State and riverine communities targeted before mid-2027	Baseline not held
Utilisation of the deployed fibre backbone	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 101,000 km built, bypassing some 130m Nigerians (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Country partnership framework	A framework in force for 2021 to 2026 with an indicative US\$912m first-cycle allocation	A nine-year framework prepared but not launched, with job creation the organising objective and no committed envelope on the record	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Cross-border terrestrial fibre route	Did not exist	A 2,000 km protected terrestrial route across four countries, live and carrying wholesale traffic with direct interconnection into data centres in each city. Its operator marked a first year in the country in August 2026, describing a 2,000km protected corridor from Goma to Mombasa connecting Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi within a network spanning sixteen African countries	ADVANCED
Information and communications for development appropriation	RWF 5,395,372,252 domestic against RWF 45.06bn external for 2025/26	RWF 4,851,958,667 domestic against RWF 65,798,446,317 external for 2026/27	REGRESSED
Internet penetration	34% in 2024 rising to 38% at mid-2025	42.6% projected for end-2025 with 1.35m households on home internet, and no measured 2026 figure published	ADVANCED
Mobile and internet subscriptions	13,194,764 mobile-cellular and 10,064,499 internet subscriptions a year earlier	14,001,080 mobile-cellular subscriptions at 97.1 per 100 inhabitants and 10,738,906 internet subscriptions	ADVANCED
New subsea cable system	Did not exist	A 25,000 km system with 48 fibre pairs and twenty landing points across fifteen countries, reached from Rwanda over terrestrial fibre rather than a landing	ADVANCED
Regional communications satellite feasibility study	Did not exist	Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda and South Sudan opened a joint bank account to fund a feasibility study for a regional communications satellite, taking partner-state contributions with a 30 September 2026 deadline to deposit and launch the study, under the roadmap settled at the April 2026 Nairobi meeting	ADVANCED
Satellite reseller authorisation	Did not exist	A certified reseller with packages for health, education and non-profits and small-business plans planned	ADVANCED
Second-generation network switch-off	None published	A target rather than a fixed deadline, conditional on the earlier shutdown's outcome, coverage, service continuity, legacy-handset counts and migration of dependent systems	ADVANCED
Shared tower investment	Did not exist	US\$44.4m of equity into shared tower infrastructure leased to mobile operators, aimed at underserved rural coverage	ADVANCED
Third-generation network switch-off	None published	A nationwide shutdown fixed for 2027-06-30, with pilot shutdowns in selected areas during 2026 and critical-system migration completed in the first half of 2027; extensions temporary and regulator-approved	ADVANCED
Voice over fourth-generation networks	Not in service	Voice over fourth-generation networks live for compatible handsets, with no coverage, handset-base, subscriber figure or completion date published	ADVANCED
Digital acceleration project	A US\$200m World Bank commitment for 2022 to 2026, 55% complete with US\$47.2m disbursed	The same, with no progress or completion figure published since July 2025 against a December 2026 closing date	NO CHANGE
Fifth-generation network	Commercial service launched June 2025	The same, with no coverage, site count or subscriber figure published since	NO CHANGE
Government network	A planned resilient national government network linking institutions to cell level	The same, with no build, coverage or completion figure published	NO CHANGE
National broadband policy	A technology-neutral policy in force with operators refarming spectrum	The same, with additional spectrum allocated across multiple operators	NO CHANGE

Sao Tome and Principe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CST national network (antennas/schools expansion)	Expansion plan to more communities/schools announced, larger schools first	35th antenna live at Agua Ize, ending prolonged local network instability	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet service	US-backed intent announced, no service	Live: Standard kit STN 5,500 (~US\$257); Residential STN 1,700/mo (~US\$79.5)	ADVANCED
Submarine cable to Principe (STP Digital project component)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Progress tracked as a mission objective; no completion status or timeline given	Baseline not held

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
2Africa cable landing station	Landing station built, not in service	In service: sixteen fibre pairs, 180 Tbps, carrier-neutral open access	ADVANCED
EBRD network facility	Did not exist: the bank held no Senegal investment	A senior facility of up to EUR 270m, EUR 170m committed and EUR 100m uncommitted, for 4G, 5G and accelerated fibre in Senegal and Kenya	ADVANCED
Fixed broadband subscribers	About 0.92m (2024, implied by the stated growth)	1.16m at 2025-12-31, of which more than 640,000 fibre-to-the-home	ADVANCED
Gandoul teleport satellite gateway	Did not exist: a 1972-era teleport with no low-orbit gateway	Sixteen new antennas and a Tier III room linking a low-orbit constellation to terrestrial networks	ADVANCED
Satellite operating authorisation	Did not exist: no satellite-operator authorisation framework and no service live	A five-year renewable authorisation with local-supervision, data-sovereignty and local-operator clauses, with the regulator enforcing against unauthorised Wi-Fi resale	ADVANCED
Senegal, Togo and Benin free roaming	Did not exist between the three states	Free incoming calls for up to thirty consecutive days, outgoing calls and messages at visited-country local rates, and surcharges on incoming international traffic removed	ADVANCED
Tower operator investment	Did not exist as a stated position	An announced intent of US\$150m, with no signed agreement, schedule, site count, disbursement window or counterparty operator	ADVANCED
Universal connectivity project	No state free-connectivity programme and no satellite operator authorised	A kit tour running across three regions, with a first lot of 200 of 1,000 gifted kits; the one-million-beneficiary target moved from the first half of 2026 to end-2026, with no beneficiary count published	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Via Africa cable landing	Did not exist	Senegal a named landing point on an Atlantic corridor of over 20,000 km; a three to four year build with no Senegal-specific date	ADVANCED
Mobile network latency	BASELINE NOT HELD	35.4 ms, second in sub-Saharan Africa behind Togo at 28.8 ms	Baseline not held
Rural household internet access	BASELINE NOT HELD	3% of rural households	Baseline not held

Seychelles

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Airtel Seychelles 5G network	No 5G service; network being relocated/virtualised into new datacentre (2025-08)	Commercial 5G live, second operator after CWS	ADVANCED
Starlink Seychelles (satellite ISP)	Did not exist	Live nationally, subscriptions open online, several users already active (2026-07-21/22); 28th of 54 African markets on sale	ADVANCED
Cable & Wireless Seychelles 4G/5G network	5G live since Jul 2020, unchanged at 2025-08 baseline	Unchanged; now running alongside Airtel's newer 5G network	NO CHANGE
Hytera-CWS emergency-communications MoU	MoU signed, no build reported (2025-08 baseline)	Unchanged — no build, commissioning date or further progress on record	NO CHANGE

Sierra Leone

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CSquared West Africa backbone and 2Africa West capacity	Backbone reaching Sierra Leone with no independent 2Africa route (2025-07)	2Africa West capacity added, giving automated rerouting across physically diverse paths (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National fibre backbone (SALCAB)	International capacity reported at 500+ Gbps after the SALCAB privatisation, up from 90 Gbps; no district count published (2025-07)	Fibre in 14 of 16 districts against about US\$400m invested in telecoms, with a 60% usage gap (2026-05)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Sierratel relaunch as an MVNO	State telco carrying about US\$6.3m in employee obligations and about US\$35m external debt after failed privatisations, with no partner (2025-07)	Revenue-share MVNO model agreed with Africell, which held 54.51% market share at end-2024; no relaunch date published (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Starlink connectivity for 300 government health facilities	Did not exist	One of 300 facilities connected; cost, funder, procurement route, contract term and data-residency arrangement all unpublished (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Starlink licensed satellite service	Licensed and operating; 12 universities connected through ELCOME SL (2025-01)	Two years licensed with three resellers, and the state buying it for health facilities (2026)	ADVANCED
Second submarine cable landing	Feasibility assessment under way, no landing party or route (2025-07)	Still at feasibility, with a US\$15m investment cited at 2026 stakeholder meetings; no route, landing party or date published	NO CHANGE
SOGEB-Leonecom fibre interconnection at Pamelap	Interconnected at 42.5 Gbps under the Guinea-Sierra Leone Digital Pact 2024 (2025-06)	42.5 Gbps, with 100 Gbps stated for 2026; no upgrade confirmed on the record	NO CHANGE
Spectrum licensing and management framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Regulator seeking 15-20-year licences, staggered spectrum fees, NGSO guidelines and an automated spectrum management system; none adopted on the record (2026-03)	Baseline not held

Somalia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink satellite service	Licensed in April 2025 after about two and a half years of talks, not yet available nationwide (2025-08)	Available across the country at US\$390 for hardware and US\$70 a month, US\$210 for the mini terminal, with a first local reseller from September 2025 (2025-09)	ADVANCED
Submarine cable landings and their regulatory framework	Landings at Mogadishu, Berbera and Bosaso with no submarine cable regulatory framework on record (2025-08)	Working group opened on outage management, competition and a regulatory framework; no framework published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Internet use and price	BASELINE NOT HELD	10.7m internet users, more than half the population; median fixed download 18.76 Mbps, up 67% year on year; mobile data about US\$0.50 per GB (2025-10)	Baseline not held

South Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Bayobab national and cross-border fibre network	No licensed national backbone operator	15-year licence effective 16 October 2025; build in execution linking the eastern and western corridors through Juba (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Mobile coverage extension in Kauto Administrative Area	One site, at Kuron	One site, at Kuron; four further sites requested and an expected February 2026 extension not delivered (2026-07)	STALLED
National fibre backbone programme (2,400 km via Kenya)	US\$9m design budget approved, no route announced (2025-06)	2,400 km route announced and fibre tendering stated to start in the second half of 2026; no construction start or completion date published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
National Spectrum Management and 5G Strategy	Did not exist	Development launched; no strategy, band plan, auction design or timetable published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Regional communications satellite feasibility study	Did not exist	Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda and South Sudan opened a joint bank account to fund a feasibility study for a regional communications satellite, taking partner-state contributions with a 30 September 2026 deadline to deposit and launch the study, under the roadmap settled at the April 2026 Nairobi meeting	ADVANCED
Telecommunications tariff exchange-rate adjustment	Did not exist	Three operators raised voice and data prices on 17 August 2026 following an earlier June increase, and the legislature has challenged the repeated rises and moved to summon the information minister	REGRESSED
MTN South Sudan mobile operator licence	Licensed	Licensed	NO CHANGE
Regulator's power to order platform blocking	Exercised January 2025; no authorising instrument published	Exercised January 2025; no authorising instrument published	NO CHANGE
South Sudan International Gateway (SSIGW)	Operated by MGI Communications	Operated by MGI Communications, now under NCA oversight (2026-01)	NO CHANGE

Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Horizon Fiber Initiative (Djibouti-Ethiopia-Sudan corridor)	Memorandum of understanding only (Dec 2024)	Binding tripartite agreement; ~2,800km corridor, 144 fibre pairs, ~14ms target latency, linking Djibouti subsea landings via Ethiopia to Port Sudan, interconnecting with the existing Port Sudan-Jeddah cable	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink satellite internet – regulatory status	Unlicensed since SAF/TPRA import ban (Dec 2023); widely used via smuggled terminals; both SAF and RSF renting/confiscating regionally	Status contested and informal, with a new instance of localised enforcement: an armed group ordered every public market in a West Kordofan locality closed and satellite internet services cut off indefinitely from 26 August 2026, in a decision reported on 25 August 2026 by a local emergency room, which warned that severing satellite connectivity would cut displaced families off from relatives and from incoming remittances in a locality already under deteriorating security and living conditions; the order coincided with reinforcements arriving from Darfur	REGRESSED
4G tower expansion programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	60 towers built; 200 more planned for 2026	Baseline not held

Tanzania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G deployment	1,255 5G facilities and 30.13% population coverage (2025-12)	1,804 facilities on 10,084 towers, 32.83% population coverage and 11.04% geographic, with every region holding at least three base stations	ADVANCED
Active mobile subscriptions and penetration	86.77m active subscriptions, 133.3% penetration (2024)	117m telecom subscriptions and 89.7% internet penetration for the quarter ending June 2026 on the regulator's own count, with internet subscriptions up 6.48% to 62.79 million, data consumption up 11.65% to 1,041 petabytes, mobile-money subscriptions up 7.5% to 87.05 million, and smartphone penetration at 44.74% against featurephone penetration of 83.38%	ADVANCED
Kenya border terrestrial fibre link	The backbone connected to Mombasa on the same route, with no launched cross-border service	Launched by both ministers, with the national backbone integrated with submarine cable capacity	ADVANCED
Kilimanjaro One submarine cable	Did not exist	1,900 km from Dar es Salaam to Mauritius with two branches; construction stated from 2026 and completion late 2027	ADVANCED
National ICT Broadband Backbone	13,820 km laid of a 16,280 km planned total at April 2025, 109 of 139 districts, all 111 service delivery points done; TZS 73bn for 2025/26	15,167 km at December 2025 at 2,000 Gbps, all mainland regional headquarters and 122 of 139 districts, linked to seven neighbouring countries; in one region 942.5 km built against 65 citizens connected region-wide (2026-07)	ADVANCED, UPTAKE STALLED
Satellite broadband service	A distribution deal covering Tanzania among fourteen markets announced 2025-05-06, service not live	Live, with direct-to-cell and backhaul reseller arrangements alongside	ADVANCED
Smartphone users and penetration	29.8m users and 41.82% penetration (2025-12)	28.5m users and 42.5% penetration	REGRESSED
Tower and fibre public-private handover	Under construction since the May 2023 launch: 758 new towers plus 304 upgrades, not yet transferred	758 towers and about 1,100 km of fibre transferred to government across three corridors plus metro fibre	ADVANCED
TTCL fibre-to-the-home programme	A target of one million customers by 2027 set in March 2023, rollout not begun	The target now one million by 2028, rollout begun in 2026 across seven areas; 63,843 fixed lines, third behind two competitors, and 2.78% of mobile internet	ADVANCED, TARGET SLIPPED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Zanzibar broadband partnership	An unpriced memorandum only, with no value, term or household target	TZS 300bn over twenty years, targeting about 100,000 households on the two islands in the first three years	ADVANCED
636-mast programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	636 masts due March 2027, with a second programme of 280 masts stated under way	Baseline not held
758-tower rural connectivity project	Not held	A TZS 126bn project - TZS 55bn from the World Bank and TZS 71bn from the universal service fund - has connected 8.5 million people across 1,400 villages; the same report to Parliament records 14,826 data controllers and processors registered with the data protection commission by June 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Backbone users connected in Dodoma Region	BASELINE NOT HELD	65 people connected in the whole region	Baseline not held
Leading operator network investment and coverage	Baseline not held	27.7 million customers and capital expenditure up 85.1% to TZS 323.9 billion for the year ended 2026-03-31, with 444 new 4G and 25 new 5G sites lifting 4G population coverage to 76.3%, mobile money customers up 22.6%, 466 rural sites built since 2013 under the government rural connectivity programme and a TZS 53.5 billion dividend approved	BASELINE NOT HELD
Second operator fibre-to-the-home and business service	Did not exist	Home, business and institutional fibre launched in the capital across Ilazo, Ipagala, Swaswa, Mjini Kati and Barabara za Namba, with coverage to extend progressively across the city as demand grows. No subscriber, premises-passed, speed or price figure is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS free-roaming arrangement with Senegal and Benin	Not in force; regional ministers had set full implementation by all operators by end-2025	In force - free incoming calls for up to 30 consecutive days, outgoing calls and messages at visited-country local rates, preferential data tariffs, and no surcharge on incoming international traffic	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Licence for E-Space Togo to operate Internet-of-Things networks	Did not exist	A five-year renewable licence to establish and operate electronic-communications networks for services based on the Internet of Things, distinct from the incumbent mobile and internet authorisations	ADVANCED
West Africa subsea backbone with second-route diversity	Landing at Lome on a single system plus terrestrial backbone, exposed to landing concentration at Accra, Lagos and Abidjan	An independent second subsea route with automated rerouting, after three multi-country West African outages in twenty-eight months	ADVANCED
5G service on 100 MHz at 3400-3500 MHz	Commercial 5G on sale since 2020, with no published national 5G strategy	Unchanged, and about 1 per cent of devices in the market are 5G-capable (2026-04)	NO CHANGE
Starlink licence	Not licensed, with imported kits in use through roaming in a regulatory grey zone (2025-01)	Still not licensed; Togo sits in the available-from-2026 column of a 29-country survey with no licence on record	NO CHANGE

Tunisia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
5G commercial service	In service across all three operators since February 2025, under fifteen-year licences awarded in November 2024 (2025-08)	In service; the regulator's fixed-wireless obligation carries a 30 Mbps floor and a 50% contractual-speed guarantee, and fixed-wireless lines rose from 9,425 at launch to 319,554 by May 2026 (2026-08)	ADVANCED, IN REACH
Medusa submarine cable landing at Bizerte	Under construction; the hosting agreement was signed in May 2023 and the cable had not landed (2025-08)	Landed 31 October 2025 as the cable's first African landing and in service from 3 June 2026, with Orange Tunisia owning and operating the landing station and the roughly 1,050 km Tunisian segment at up to 24 Tbps (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Tunisie Telecom dedicated Medusa fibre pair	Contracted at 20 Tbps in February 2025, not in service (2025-08)	In service on the operational cable; the operator's claim of an eightfold capacity increase is about its own purchased capacity, not the cable (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite service licence	Application pending since January 2023, with technical trials run in 2023 and no licence (2025-08)	Still unlicensed after three years; the operator opened US\$9 refundable pre-order deposits in February 2026, and a March 2025 feasibility study recommended a time-limited competitive licence, deferred to let 5G and fibre consolidate (2026-06)	NO CHANGE
Cite Numerique d'Ennahli technology park	Not held	The grands projets commission ordered immediate procurement to complete the park at a review session chaired by the Prime Minister on 10 August 2026, alongside unrelated power-station and hospital projects	BASELINE NOT HELD

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Active mobile subscriptions	45.7m active mobile subscriptions (2025-09-30)	About 47m active SIMs (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Northern Corridor regional satellite	Did not exist	Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda and South Sudan opened a joint bank account at a Kampala bank to fund a feasibility study for the regional communications satellite, taking partner-state contributions with a 30 September 2026 deadline to deposit and launch the study, under the roadmap settled at the April 2026 Nairobi meeting	ADVANCED
Paratus Goma-Mombasa route	Did not exist	In service via Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi; Uganda partner Roke Telekom	ADVANCED
Retail broadband and data price series	None published	Approximately USD 1.40/GB for mobile data, attributed by EACO to a 40% tax burden on smartphones (EACO regional dataset, data period 2024-2025); UCC separately asserts costs continue to decline without publishing a figure (2026-07-02)	ADVANCED
Savanna Fibre Uganda 1 Gbps fixed broadband	Did not exist	1 Gbps fixed broadband on sale	ADVANCED
Seacom Nairobi-Kampala route	Did not exist	1 Tbps live, scalable to 30 Tbps; border crossings at Malaba and Busia; about 13 ms to Mombasa	ADVANCED
Smartphones in use	18m (date not published)	20m (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Social media and OTT restriction	Facebook officially restricted since 2021; circumvention by VPN declared illegal	All social media and OTT messaging blocked; no lifting on record as at 2026-08-06	REGRESSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink operational licence	Unlicensed; access shut off on regulatory directive, no terminals operating at 2026-01-01	Licensed for five years on conditions — national gateway, physical point of presence, staffed local office, registration of every in-country device — and now live, with two domestic providers the first to switch the service on	ADVANCED
Bayobab Kampala-Malaba fibre route	In service, 260 km, over 1 Tbit/s (2025-05)	Unchanged; no capacity change or upgrade reported	NO CHANGE
Border free public Wi-Fi, Bwera and Mpondwe	In operation (2025-07)	No expansion, usage figure or further site on record	NO CHANGE
National Backbone Infrastructure Phase V	Utilisation under 30% of full capacity; Phase V approved (2023-12)	No delivery, utilisation or completion figure published as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE, NO NEWER FIGURE
MTN Uganda coverage and fibre footprint	BASELINE NOT HELD	25.4m mobile subscribers and 12.6m active data subscribers (2026-06-30); 96.2% 3G, 88.6% 4G and 19% 5G population coverage and 27,037 km fibre (2025-12-31)	Baseline not held

Zambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Border-post connectivity upgrade across five trade corridors	No named border-connectivity programme is on the record; gaps at Nakonde, Victoria Falls, Kazungula and Chirundu	A single national standard announced through the government network - tiered 10 to 100 Mbps, dual links with automatic failover, enterprise-grade firewalls - and an independent network specialist firm commissioned to audit ICT infrastructure at five border posts; no budget, timetable or completion date published	ADVANCED
Chanida-Cassacatiza cross-border fibre interconnector	Did not exist; the base records cross-border infrastructure as missing at the January 2025 appraisal	The national backbone linked to Mozambique's submarine cable network under an operator partnership, with the minister stating Zambia is now fibre-linked to eight neighbours	ADVANCED
Government Wide Area Network	Site works complete at 12 Western Province sites, with last-mile connections by the state operator outstanding and the network not fully usable	All 116 councils reported connected and phase 1 completed, and North-Western Province local authorities and post offices connected over fibre; connectivity gaps persist at four named border posts	ADVANCED
GovLink Private 4G	Did not exist; no government-owned mobile network is on the record before July 2026	Government-owned shared 4G network for public institutions, live at Ndola Teaching Hospital, with the national electronic health record and its hospital tier migrating onto it; run by the state ICT institute with three named partners and the health ministry	ADVANCED
Mobile connections	19.9m connections, 92.1% of population (January 2025), down 1.1% year on year	23.5m connections, 106% of population (October 2025), up 1.3m year on year, of which 92.4% classed as broadband - a share the publisher states is not a proxy for mobile internet use	ADVANCED
National fibre network length	10,000 km of fibre optic cable in place, with the acceleration project aiming to add at least 2,000 km (World Bank appraisal, January 2025)	Expanded from 15,000 km in 2021 to more than 45,000 km, and national coverage 94% (minister, 2026-05-15) - government-reported and not reconcilable with the appraisal figure	ADVANCED, FIGURES IRRECONCILABLE
Quality-of-service enforcement regime	The regulator investigating internet service disruptions and requesting an operator report; no enforcement or reporting regime stated	The regulator states it will take visible action against mobile operators over poor quality of service and will publish quarterly public network-performance reports; no report, penalty or named operator action is on file	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink service in Zambia	Live since October 2023, with state ICT institute kits in underserved public facilities since 2024 and installations at a rural clinic and two primary schools reported 2025-09-29	Kits reported at 23 youth resource centres nationwide during 2025, converting them into digital transformation centres; Zambia with Nigeria and Zimbabwe accounts for approximately 64% of an estimated 300,000 African subscribers (June 2026, vendor-market report estimate)	ADVANCED
Communication Towers Project Phase 2	US\$302,034,321.68 China Eximbank government concessional loan signed 2017-08-04 financing a vendor contract, 87.8% disbursed as of July 2022; scope 808 communication towers and 1,009 wireless stations, targeting 92% network coverage and data access for 40% of the country from a 5% baseline	Unchanged; no completion, handover or final tower count is held	NO CHANGE
Independent tower portfolio	Sole independent tower operator with over 1,700 towers serving all major mobile operators; US\$65,523,810 in development-finance equity committed in 2015 and 2017 and exited in March 2021, plus a US\$75,000,000 senior loan in 2021	Unchanged; no tower count, ownership change or investment after 2021 is held	NO CHANGE
Internet users as a share of population	7.13m users, 33.0% of population (January 2025), up 2.8% year on year with the rate unchanged; 14.5m offline	7.29m users, 33.0% of population (October 2025), up 199,000 year on year with the rate unchanged; 14.8m offline	NO CHANGE
National ICT Development Project Phase II, backbone extension	US\$333,200,000 China Eximbank preferential buyer's credit signed 2017-12-28, to be on-lent to the electricity utility against a US\$392m vendor contract; scope 2,700 km of backbone across 64 sites, 3,600 km of metropolitan network in 17 districts and 2,750 km of access network; 0% disbursed	Unchanged; no drawdown, cancellation or construction record is held	NO CHANGE
Umoja cable terrestrial segment through Zambia	Announced May 2024 as a terrestrial route from Kenya through six countries to South Africa, built with a regional operator, with no service date held	Same route; ready for service stated as 2027. No Zambian landing point, capacity, counterparty or regulatory approval is held	NO CHANGE
Direct-to-cell satellite trials	No position held on satellite direct-to-cell in Zambia	Zambia named by an operator as a site of its direct-to-cell satellite trials, in an argument for regulatory parity between terrestrial operators and satellite entrants	BASELINE NOT HELD

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Median fixed broadband download speed	16.50 Mbps, down 38.0% year on year (January 2025), corroborating the load-shedding constraint on digital services	No later reading is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
5G base stations	319 (Q3 2025, derived from the regulator's stated increase in Q4)	379 (Q1 2026); 18.9% population coverage and 0.0% rural coverage (Q4 2025)	ADVANCED
Cross-border fibre corridor to Zambia	Public-private partnership signed June 2025; no route live	Phase 1 live at 800 Gbps equipped on equipment rated above 10 Tbps; phase 2 to Livingstone due September 2026; no investment amount disclosed by either party	ADVANCED
Econet InfraCo	A wholly owned subsidiary holding the group's passive infrastructure; no carve-out on record at 2025-08	Separately listed, 70.000% held by the parent, 2,992,163,203 shares issued; 90 base stations deployed in the quarter to May 2026	ADVANCED
Government arrears owed to the state fixed operator	US\$19.2m (prior financial year)	Close to US\$42m, also given as ZiG1.2bn	REGRESSED
Government satellite kit donation programme	250 kits handed to local authorities (2025-07-24)	More than 400 health facilities hold kits, unactivated for want of subscription payment, with 300 more planned; 8,000 kits separately reported donated to the education ministry	ADVANCED, ACTIVATION STALLED
Internet penetration rate	82.87% (Q3 2025)	84.55% on 13,252,877 subscriptions (Q4 2025); the ICT minister stated 87% in July 2026	ADVANCED
Parent company's stock exchange listing	Listed on the domestic stock exchange	Left the exchange after 27 years; the group's listed vehicle is the infrastructure company on the foreign-currency exchange	CLOSED
Satellite terminal subscriptions	40,146 (Q2 2025), the last quarter ending before the window opened	67,057 (Q4 2025), up 31.62% on Q3 2025	ADVANCED
State mobile operator turnaround plan	US\$40m loss in 2022; US\$160m revenue projected for 2024	US\$210m revenue for 2025, up 62%; a US\$278m 2026 target reported at risk; the chief executive's contract was terminated 2026-08-04	ADVANCED, CHIEF EXECUTIVE TERMINATED
State operator's satellite reseller revenue	US\$215,000 (2024)	US\$3.7m (2025)	ADVANCED
Uncapped fibre package at US\$99	Two fixed operators cut prices and introduced unlimited packages in August 2025	Priced against the satellite operator's US\$100 plan; the incumbent's fixed-traffic share fell from 58.90% in Q3 2025 to 48.41% in Q4 2025	ADVANCED
Satellite operator's licence terms and fee	Licensed since September 2024; terms not held	A telecommunication licence for network services and a national internet service provider licence, both issued 2024-09-06, conditional on the regulator clearing every agent, dealer and provider distributing terminals; the widely cited US\$575,000 is the trade press's arithmetic on the 2021 fee schedule, not a regulator figure	NO CHANGE
Starlink satellite service	Licensed and operating; local resale permitted from January 2025	Licensed, with the state operator and other agents reselling; 17.23% share of alternative fixed internet technologies (Q4 2025)	NO CHANGE
Broadband mapping programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under way with the three main operators; no map, coverage output or date published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National fibre backbone length	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 19,000 km (Q1 2026), up 33.83% on Q4 2025, against the regulator's 14,357 km at Q4 2025	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Tower relocation programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Described as being implemented, redistributing towers from over-serviced urban areas to marginalised communities; no site count, cost or completion date published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity for Africa	Did not exist	Adopted, committing member states to technology-neutral regulation, continental harmonisation, fair access to spectrum and fibre, shared infrastructure and data governance; the text itself is not published	ADVANCED
Harmonised national broadband mapping project	Did not exist	A 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators - Benin, Botswana, Burundi, Ethiopia, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Malawi, Nigeria, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe - with a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training opened at Lilongwe for practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, hosted by the Malawian regulator and supported by the European Union	ADVANCED
Africa Digital Connectivity Infrastructure Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Phase 1, Country Pilots, put out as an open consultancy tender at a stated budget of US\$165,000, funded jointly by the African Development Bank, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance; the pilot countries and the terms of reference are not established	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Mobile internet users and their measured economic value	Baseline not held	416 million Africans used mobile internet in 2025, generating a measured US\$240bn of economic value, put at 7.8% of continental GDP	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Powertel-Paratus cross-border fibre corridor	Did not exist	Phase 1 live and carrying traffic, on a route to link Zimbabwe with Botswana, Zambia and South Africa	ADVANCED
SADC regional internet exchange point	No host selection process on record	BoFiNet of Botswana and one Zimbabwean company shortlisted; no award held in the eight months since	ADVANCED
SADC Regional Infrastructure Development Master Plan	In force since 2012, carrying the ICT sector plan for a Digital SADC	Unchanged, with under two years to its horizon; no revision or successor held	NO CHANGE
Regional connectivity indicators	BASELINE NOT HELD	Internet penetration 57.2%, 4G population coverage 79.2% and mobile penetration 95.2%, the last already past the regional target set for 2030 (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
SADC shared satellite	BASELINE NOT HELD	A technical submission on orbital positions filed with the ITU and the radiocommunication sector met to secure the slot, with a working group created to assess financing mechanisms and payment model; the project is stated to be at an early stage and no cost, launch date or operator is held (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
CSquared West Africa backbone	Carrying regional traffic on its own subsea and terrestrial routes	Capacity on the 2Africa West system added for route diversity, after three multi-country outages in 28 months at the Accra, Lagos and Abidjan landing concentration	ADVANCED
EllaLink Mauritania branch	Launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025, with nothing laid	Coastal landing complete, offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED
Via Africa submarine cable	Did not exist	A consortium memorandum signed by Canalink, GUILAB, International Mauritania Telecom, the Orange group, Sonatel and Silverlinks for a Europe-to-South-Africa system landing in Mauritania, Senegal, Guinea, Cote d'Ivoire and Nigeria; no cost, contract or in-service date held	ADVANCED
Nigeria-Burkina Faso connectivity partnership	Did not exist	Technical teams to assess routes through Niger and through Benin, on a stated aim of halving the cost of internet access in Burkina Faso	BASELINE NOT HELD
WACS cable repair logistics	BASELINE NOT HELD	The cable's spare-fibre depot sits at Brest, far from the stretch between Senegal and Congo where most outages occur, so a repair ship had to sail from Portland to Abidjan	Baseline not held

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